

We've been discussing the free will defense as a response to the argument from evil. This response assumes something about us: that we have free will.

But what does this mean?

To say that we have free will is to say that some of our actions are up to us; they are under our control.

Can we come up with a more informative **definition** of free will? What is it for an action to be up to us, or to be under our control?

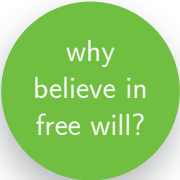
Any definition we give will be (for reasons which will become clear) controversial. But notice that that does not mean that we can't know anything about which actions (if any) are free. To use an example we've discussed before, it is notoriously difficult to define words like "table" and "chair." But we surely know that some things are tables, and some things are chairs.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

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control version

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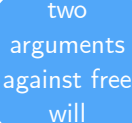
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freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to



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first let's think about how Edwards'

responding to Edwards' argument. But

We'll shortly consider some ways of

argument might be related to an argument

for fatalsn.

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

Suppose that someone did not believe in

there were truths about all our future

actions. Could they give an argument

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

similar to Edwards' argument?

with reference to the being of truth about

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

God only shows up in premises (2) and

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

our future actions.



4. If we have no choice about p , and no

1. We have no direct facts.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

perform a certain action (1,2)

5* We have noticed that the fact

God knows that in the future I will



some action, then I will prefer that

all of our activities.

then we have the choice about q.

(3, 4, 5)

will perform various actions.

3 We have not the fact that

acaioid.

0 We have achieved what we

2*In the past, there were truths about

that if it is true that I will perform

The fatalist argument

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

things as fate, then there is no free will.

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

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